

Doctor J. P. Young
Page 2.

But, in God's blessed Name, who can claim exemption from such Guilt? I for one could never dare think of such a thing. Can you Doctor? Then, if "gratitude for favors is one of the first and surest indications of intelligence", then, in the name of everything that is logical, and intelligent and holy; let us be men enough to acknowledge our weakness, our stupidity, our real insanity and guilt in the sight of Heaven: that by such humble acknowledgement - How mercifully simple and easy! we may recover our friendship and our peace with our God in Heaven -- at once -- the divinely gentle and loving Governor of the universe, and the no less divine Avenger of the proud and the stubborn who refuse to appreciate His merciful goodness and to cooperate with His gracious condescensions.

Something for me as well as you Friend, and us all to think about. Not? Then Doctor: you possibly remember reading the great encyclical of Pope Leo XIII on the Holy Eucharist, even when it first came out. Anyhow, I think it has been generally considered a decided master-piece, at once like-inspired and indeed very inspiring. Here is a notable passage from it that I have often considered and that have often wished were proclaimed again and again, in season and out of season:

"History bears witness that the virtues of the Christian life have flourished best wherever and whenever the frequent reception of the Eucharist has most prevailed. And on the other hand it is no less certain that in days when men have ceased to care for this heavenly bread, and have lost their appetite for it, the practice of Christian religion has gradually lost its force and vigor."

And because society is made up of individuals these great, great documents, - the encyclicals - pertain to the instruction and the welfare of the individual and society in general alike. Hence it goes on, like a divine admonition and exhortation:"

"And indeed it was as a needful measure of precaution against a complete falling away that Innocent III., in the Council of the Lateran, most strictly enjoined that no Christian should abstain from receiving the Communion of the Lord's Body at least in the solemn paschal season." Ah! "as a needful measure against a complete falling away..."